

Mengxuan Helen Qiao

helen.qiao.18@ucl.ac.uk |  www.linkedin.com/in/helen-mengxuan-qiao

London, United Kingdom

EDUCATION

- **PhD candidate in Experimental Psychology (Supervisor: Prof. David Lagnado)** *September 2023 - Present*
University College London, University of London *London, United Kingdom*
 - Research areas: judgment and decision-making, experimental jurisprudence, law in context, legal Artificial Intelligence, evidential reasoning, causal reasoning, Bayesian reasoning, coherence reasoning, and belief updating
- **MSc Crime Science (Distinction)** *September 2021 - September 2022*
University College London, University of London *London, United Kingdom*
 - Key modules: Quantitative Methods, Qualitative Methods, Cybercrime, Organised Crime, Preventing Crimes, Investigation and Detection, and Horizon Scanning and the Changing Nature of Crime
- **BSc Psychology (1st Class Honours)** *September 2018 - July 2021*
University College London, University of London *London, United Kingdom*
 - Key modules: Statistics, Quantitative and Qualitative Research Methods, Computer Programming (Python), Human Computer Interaction, Decision-Making, Language and Cognition, Social Psychology, Forensic Psychology

RESEARCH & TEACHING EXPERIENCES

- **Researcher Assistant** *June 2026 - Present*
Queen's University Belfast, School of Law *Remote*
 - Working on projects focused on the impact of deepfakes on trust in evidence of human rights violations, and how open source evidence has transformed fact-finding.
- **Affiliated Researcher** *August 2025 - Present*
University of Groningen, Faculty of Law *Remote*
 - Working on the project Preventing Miscarriages of Justice, funded by the Netherlands Organisation for Scientific Research (NWO).
- **BSc Final Year Project Supervisor** *September 2025 - Present*
University College London, Department of Experimental Psychology *London, United Kingdom*
 - Supervised third-year undergraduate students on their dissertations.
 - Student's project 'Who Takes the Blame When AI Therapy Fails, and the Praise When It Succeeds? Responsibility Attributions Across Human and AI Agents' won the John Draper prize at UCL Psychology Summer Festival.
- **Visiting Researcher at UCLA Reasoning lab** *September 2025 - November 2025*
University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA), Department of Psychology *Los Angeles, United States*
 - Worked with Professor Keith Holyoak on coherence-based reasoning in legal decision-making and computational modelling of evidential probability judgments.
- **Researcher Assistant** *August 2024 - April 2026*
Swansea University, Hillary Rodham Clinton School of Law *Remote*
 - Worked on the project Trust in User-generated Evidence (TRUE), selected for funding by the European Research Council and funded by a UKRI Frontier Research grant.
- **Postgraduate Teaching Assistant (seminar leader, demonstrator)** *September 2023 - Present*
University College London, Department of Experimental Psychology *London, United Kingdom*
 - Assisted lecturers with the delivery of courses; delivered small group classes.

SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS & AWARDS

- Donald H. Berman Award for Best Student Paper nomination at ICAIL 2026
- Institute for Humane Studies Residency Funding grant for my project on A Computational Approach to Integrate Coherence Reasoning and Bayesian Principles in Legal Decision-Making (\$7000) 2026
- UCL PALS Graduate Conference Fund to present at the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci) Conference in San Francisco, US (£890.5) 2025
- UCL Bogue Fellowship for research visit to Professor Keith Holyoak's Reasoning Lab at University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA), US (£4,353.80) 2025
- Institute for Humane Studies Expense Support for my project on Legal Decision-Making in Large Language Models (\$3,640) 2025
- The Society for Applied Research in Memory and Cognition (SARMAC) Conference Student Travel Grant in Kildare, Ireland (\$855.29) 2025
- UCL PALS Graduate Conference Fund to present at the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci) Conference in Rotterdam, the Netherlands (£390) 2024
- UCL Department of Security & Crime Science Bursary Scholarship Award (£4000) 2021

PUBLICATIONS

- **Qiao, M. H.**, Cheung, V., Hampson, L. L., & Lagnado, D. (2026). Biased Judge: Recency Effects, Cautious Convictions, and Conservative Updating in GPT-4o's Legal Decisions. In *Proceedings of the nineteenth international conference on artificial intelligence and law* (pp. xx).
- **Qiao, M. H.***, Kamper, D. G.*, Lagnado, D. & Holyoak, K. J. (2026). Coherence and Bayesian in Legal Judgment: How Verdicts Reshape Evidence Evaluation. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 48).
- **Qiao, M. H.**, & Lagnado, D. (2025). Speak Last and Step-by-Step: The Effect of Order and Response Mode on Evidence Evaluation. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 47).
- **Qiao, M. H.***, Belkin, S.*, & Lagnado, D. (2025). Cause and Blame Attribution to AI and Human Agents in Mental Health Context. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 47).
- Cheung, V.*, **Qiao, M. H.***, & Lagnado, D. (2024). Attribution of Responsibility Between Agents in a Causal Chain of Events. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 46).

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW & PREPRINTS

- Cheung, V.*, **Qiao, M. H.***, Lagnado, D., & Brown, T. (Under review). Attribution of Responsibility Between Agents in a Causal Chain. *Cognitive Science*. https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/863eq_v1
- Brassil, M., McDermott, Y., **Qiao, M. H.**, & Liefgreen, A. (Under review). User-Generated Evidence in the Courtroom: Insights from Mock Jurors. *Law and Human Behavior*.
- Vorms, M., Tentori, K., Desai, S. D., **Qiao, M. H.**, & Lagnado, D. (Under review). The role of narratives in evidential reasoning and decision-making: Is one story better than two? *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory, and Cognition*.
- **Qiao, M. H.**, & Lagnado, D. (Preprint). Speak Last and Step-by-Step: The Effect of Order and Response Mode on Legal Decisions. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/jf93s_v1
- **Qiao, M. H.***, Kamper, D. G.*, Lagnado, D., & Holyoak, K. (In preparation). Towards a Coherence-Driven Bayesian Framework for Evidential Reasoning in Legal Decision-Making.
- Drury, K., **Qiao, M. H.**, Lagnado, D., & Smith, J. Q. (In preparation). Chain Event Graphs and Probabilistic Reasoning using Stories.

PRESENTATIONS

- **Biased Judge: Recency Effects, Cautious Convictions, and Conservative Updating in GPT-4o's Legal Decisions.** Talk at *the International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Law (ICAIL)*, Singapore. 2026
- **Coherence and Bayesian in Legal Judgment: How Verdicts Reshape Evidence Evaluation.** Poster at *48th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci)*, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil. 2026
- **Towards a Coherence-Driven Bayesian Framework for Evidential Reasoning.** Invited speaker at *Putting Evidence on the Stand workshop*, Groningen, the Netherlands. 2026
- **Coherence-Based and Bayesian Reasoning – Verdict Reshaping Evidence Evaluation.** Talk and poster at *PALS PhD Conference*, Windsor, UK. 2026
- **Recency Effects, Cautious Convictions, and Conservative Updating in GPT-4o's Legal Decisions.** Talk at *AI for evidential reasoning workshop, 38th International Conference on Legal Knowledge and Information Systems (JURIX)*, Turin, Italy. 2025
- **Speak Last and Step-by-Step: The Effect of Order and Response Mode on Evidence Evaluation.** Talk at *47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci)*, San Francisco, US. 2025
- **Cause and Blame Attribution to AI and Human Agents in Mental Health Context.** Poster at *47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci)*, San Francisco, US. 2025
- **The Effect of Order and Response Mode on Evidence Evaluation and Integration.** Talk at *The Society for Applied Research in Memory and Cognition's (SARMAC) 15th Biennial Meeting*, Kildare, Ireland. 2025
- **Speak Last and Step-by-Step: The Effect of Order and Response Mode on Evidence Evaluation.** Poster at *PALS PhD Conference*, Windsor, UK. 2025
- **Misinformation on Trial: Juries, Evidence, and Decision-Making.** Respondent at *Researching Digital Misinformation: Interdisciplinary Workshop*, Swansea, UK. 2025
- **Attribution of Responsibility Between Agents in a Causal Chain.** Talk at *46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci)*, Rotterdam, the Netherlands. 2024

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese (native); English (full professional proficiency), French (intermediate)
- **Technical Skill:** R, SPSS, Stata, Python, Minitab, L^AT_EX, Qualtrics, Gorilla

REFERENCES

Available upon request